Appendix G: Validation of the Pre-Test and Post-Test Writing Prompts

This appendix presents the validation process of the pre-test and post-test writing prompts used in the study. To ensure the validity and comparability of the two writing tasks, both prompts were reviewed by two experienced secondary-school English language teachers with more than ten years of teaching experience at the same institution.

The two teachers evaluated the prompts in terms of clarity, appropriateness for second-year scientific-stream students, alignment with the Algerian secondary-school English syllabus, and equivalence of difficulty between the pre-test and post-test tasks. Their feedback was used to revise and refine the final versions of the prompts before their use in the main study.

1. Initial Versions of the Prompts

1.1 Initial Pre-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay about water pollution and its effects on people's health.

1.2 Initial Post-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay explaining how magnetic fields work with examples.

2. Teachers' Feedback on the Initial Prompts

2.1 Teacher 1's Feedback on the Pre-Test Prompt

Teacher 1 considered the topic relevant and familiar to students because environmental issues are included in the secondary-school English curriculum. However, the teacher noted that the prompt did not fully represent a complete situation of integration because it lacked a clear context, a specified audience, an expected length, and an explicit communicative purpose.

2.2 Teacher 1's Feedback on the Post-Test Prompt

Teacher 1 indicated that the topic was appropriate for second-year scientific-stream students because magnetism is related to their scientific background. However, the prompt was considered underdeveloped as a situation of integration. Although the type of discourse was mentioned, the task did not clearly specify the context, audience, length, or purpose.

2.3 Teacher 2's Feedback on the Pre-Test Prompt

Teacher 2 found the topic of water pollution suitable for the learners' level and relevant to themes commonly addressed in secondary-school English. Nevertheless, the teacher suggested that the prompt should be more contextualized. The task needed to identify the writing situation, the target readers, the expected length, and the reason for writing.

2.4 Teacher 2's Feedback on the Post-Test Prompt

Teacher 2 stated that the topic of magnetic fields was suitable for scientific-stream students and could be used as an English writing task. However, the teacher observed that the prompt was too general and needed further refinement. The task required a clearer setting, a defined audience, a word limit, and a more precise communicative purpose.

3. Revisions Made Based on Teachers' Feedback

Based on the teachers' feedback, both prompts were revised to include the essential components of a complete situation of integration: context, audience, length, type of discourse, and purpose. The revised prompts were then submitted again to the two teachers for final validation.

4. Final Versions of the Prompts

4.1 Final Pre-Test Prompt

Topic: Your school is preparing an awareness campaign about the dangers of water pollution in your town. Your teacher asked you to write an expository essay of about 120 words for your school magazine in which you explain its effects on people's health.

4.2 Final Post-Test Prompt

Topic: Your school is organizing a science exhibition about magnetism. Write an expository essay of about 120 words for your school magazine in which you explain to your classmates how magnetic fields work.

Validation Form for the Pre-Test and Post-Test Writing Prompts

Title of Study: The Impact of an Integrated Correction Model on Essay-Writing Performance of Algerian Secondary School Students: The Case of Second-Year Scientific Students at Larbi Tebessi Secondary School-Tebessa

Principal Investigators: Mouloud HECIDA /Ismail HADJADJ

Contacts: (mouloudhs@gmail.com)/ (ismail.hadjadj.0@gmail.com)

Affiliation: Echahid Cheick Larbi Tebessi University / Department of English.

Supervising Institution: Echahid Cheick Larbi Tebessi Secondary School, Tebessa, Algeria.

Purpose of the Form: This form aims to validate the pre-test and post-test writing prompts before their use in the main study. The teacher is kindly asked to evaluate the prompts in terms of clarity, suitability, syllabus alignment, task type, and equivalence of difficulty.

Teacher Information

Teacher Code	Teacher . 2
Teaching Experience	23 years
Institution	Houari . Boumediene . secondary school, Tebessa .

Initial Versions of the Prompts

Initial Pre-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay about water pollution and its effects on people's health.

Initial Post-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay explaining how magnetic fields work with examples.

Rating Scale

1 : Not appropriate
2 : Slightly appropriate
3 : Appropriate but needs revision
4 : Appropriate
5 : Highly appropriate

Equivalence of the Two Prompts

Do you think the pre-test and post-test prompts are sufficiently comparable in terms of difficulty, discourse type, expected length, and students' background knowledge?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ Yes, but minor revisions are needed
- ☐ No

Comments:

The two prompts can be considered comparable because they both ask students to write expository essays and are appropriate for the target learners. However, they should be revised to follow the same structure and to include the essential elements of a complete writing situation.

Final Recommendation

Please select one option:

- ☐ The prompts are valid and can be used without revision.
- ☒ The prompts are valid but need minor revisions.
- ☐ The prompts need major revision before use.
- ☐ The prompts are not suitable for the study.

Teacher's Signature

Teacher's Signature: Selmi Nadjla **Date:** _____

Validation Form for the Pre-Test and Post-Test Writing Prompts

Title of Study: The Impact of an Integrated Correction Model on Essay-Writing Performance of Algerian Secondary School Students: The Case of Second-Year Scientific Students at Larbi Tebessi Secondary School-Tebessa

Principal Investigators: Mouloud HECIDA /Ismail HADJADJ

Contacts: (mouloudhs@gmail.com)/ (ismail.hadjadj.0@gmail.com)

Affiliation: Echahid Cheick Larbi Tebessi University / Department of English.

Supervising Institution: Echahid Cheick Larbi Tebessi Secondary School, Tebessa, Algeria.

Purpose of the Form: This form aims to validate the pre-test and post-test writing prompts before their use in the main study. The teacher is kindly asked to evaluate the prompts in terms of clarity, suitability, syllabus alignment, task type, and equivalence of difficulty.

Teacher Information

Teacher Code	Teacher 1
Teaching Experience	15 years
Institution	Houari Boumediene

Initial Versions of the Prompts

Initial Pre-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay about water pollution and its effects on people's health.

Initial Post-Test Prompt

Topic: Write an expository essay explaining how magnetic fields work with examples.

Rating Scale

1 : Not appropriate
2 : Slightly appropriate
3 : Appropriate but needs revision
4 : Appropriate
5 : Highly appropriate

Validation Checklist

Criterion	Pre-Test Rating /5	Post-Test Rating /5
The prompt is clearly worded.	3	3
The topic is suitable for second-year secondary-school students.	4	4
The topic is appropriate for scientific-stream students.	4	5
The prompt is aligned with the Algerian secondary-school English syllabus.	4	4
The task requires expository writing.	5	5
The prompt provides a clear writing context.	2	2
The prompt specifies the intended audience.	1	1
The prompt states a clear communicative purpose.	2	2
The expected length is clear and appropriate.	1	1
The topic is familiar enough for students to write about.	5	4
The prompt is feasible within normal classroom/testing conditions.	4	4
The two prompts are comparable in level of difficulty.	3	3

Specific Feedback on the Pre-Test Prompt

Please comment on the clarity, relevance, suitability, and possible weaknesses of the pre-test prompt.

The topic is relevant and familiar to students because environmental issues are included in the secondary school English curriculum. However, the prompt does not fully represent a complete situation of integration. It needs a clearer context, a specified audience, an expected length, and an explicit communicative purpose.

Specific Feedback on the Post-Test Prompt

Please comment on the clarity, relevance, suitability, and possible weaknesses of the post-test prompt.

The topic is appropriate for second-year scientific-stream students because magnetism is related to their scientific background. However, the prompt is underdeveloped as a situation of integration. Although the type of discourse is mentioned, the task does not clearly specify the context, audience, expected length, or purpose.

Equivalence of the Two Prompts

Do you think the pre-test and post-test prompts are sufficiently comparable in terms of difficulty, discourse type, expected length, and students' background knowledge?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ Yes, but minor revisions are needed
- ☐ No

Comments:

The two prompts are generally comparable because both require expository writing and are suitable for second-year scientific-stream students. However, they need to be reformulated in the same way by adding a context, audience, word limit and communicative purpose.

Final Recommendation

Please select one option:

- ☐ The prompts are valid and can be used without revision.
- ☒ The prompts are valid but need minor revisions.
- ☐ The prompts need major revision before use.
- ☐ The prompts are not suitable for the study.

Teacher's Signature

Teacher's Signature: Khellas Nawel **Date:** _____